options for developing contacts at the summit level. He has all necessary authority with regard to that. I want to emphasize, as before, I am personally in favor of actively pursuing a business-like and constructive dialogue with you.

Sincerely,
M. Gorbachev
September 15, 1987

Once again I told Shevardnadze to tell Gorbachev we weren't going to give in on the SDI. While we didn't solve all of our problems during his visit, I think it was a turning point. We kept alive the process of trying to improve relations and he and George Shultz signed an agreement establishing crisis centers in each country that were designated to reduce the danger of an accidental war between us. Moreover, there was a new atmosphere in our dealings with the Soviets. I commented in my diary after Shevardnadze left: "They were good meetings, free of the hostility we used to see even if we were disagreeing on some things."

As Gorbachev's letter indicated, our Geneva negotiators, with concurrence by West German leaders, were moving close to a compromise regarding Germany's older Pershing missiles. Over the next few weeks, the compromise, which was ultimately pivotal to reaching agreement on the INF treaty, was completed. Under the compromise, Germany's older Pershing missiles were excluded from the U.S.-Soviet agreement, but West Germany agreed to remove them once the agreement took effect—and we agreed to remove and destroy the U.S.-controlled nuclear warheads installed in these missiles.

Even after this compromise, Gorbachev refused to set a date for a summit. He was waiting me out, still expecting